Damien Erambert

he/him | Oakland, CA

Summary

Frontend-focused Senior Software Engineer with 12 years of experience scaling product-led growth from Seed to $100M+ ARR. A technical leader who bridges the gap between high-fidelity design and industrial-grade architecture. Proven track record of leading org-wide migrations (Angular to React/TS), building foundational component libraries, and architecting high-scale systems processing 30M+ daily events.

Core Expertise

- **Architectural Leadership:** React/TypeScript migration (200k+ LOC), build tooling (Gulp, Webpack, Vite), CI/CD, and AI-assisted design-to-code workflows (Figma-to-code skill, Storybook MCP server, Figma MCP).
- **Product Stewardship:** Design systems, accessibility (A11y), WYSIWYG editor tech, email rendering.
- **Systems Engineering:** Node.js, HTML/CSS sanitization at scale, browser extensions, cross-platform (React Native).
- **Design systems:** design tokens, Panda CSS, styled-components, Storybook, Chromatic visual regression, Figma Code Connect, React Aria, accessibility (axe/WCAG), theming & dark mode, monorepo package distribution.

Experience

Senior Software Engineer November 2018 — October 2026
Front *San Francisco, CA*

- **Technical Stewardship:** Org-wide expert on frontend architecture; reviewed 4,100+ pull requests, guided backend engineers and designers shipping their first front-end code, and maintained the front-end hiring exercise; authored architecture proposals for org-wide initiatives—including a five-workstream design-system plan written separately for leadership, engineering, and design audiences.
- **Design Systems:** Built a design system from scratch for the company's AI support widget—design tokens, accessible React Aria primitives, a Figma-to-code pipeline, visual regression testing in CI—then co-owned the company-wide design-system initiative, rolling visual testing out to the main web app and removing the legacy icon system.
- **Product Surfaces:** Led the prototype and beta of the team-versus-individual inbox layout and owned auto-shared drafts; rebuilt inbox and channel settings for every channel type plus the add-channel flow, migrating settings, tags, templates, and notifications from the legacy codebase to React/TypeScript.
- **Platform Ownership:** Owned every major platform upgrade—Node.js, TypeScript, build tooling, linting—on a roughly monthly cadence, cutting lint time 50% and patching a published security vulnerability across three codebases in one day; served on the frontend on-call rotation and cleaned up crash reporting so real errors stood out; authored custom ESLint rules codifying architectural patterns org-wide.
- **Shared Language:** Built and maintained a shared component library used by 6 product teams, reducing UI drift, and rolled out a new design language—typeface, palette, theming—across a product serving 9,000+ customers.
- **Multi-Platform:** Kickstarted the mobile app redesign across successive release waves; led calendar event creation and editing in React Native, a much-requested feature for larger customers.
- **Infrastructure Evolution:** Sole owner of the marketing site through three framework migrations—supporting company growth to $100M ARR with high-performance, SEO-optimized foundations.

Founding Front-end Engineer (Employee \#4) October 2014 — November 2018
Front *Paris, France / San Francisco, CA*

- **Foundational Growth:** Joined as employee #4 and first dedicated front-end engineer during Y Combinator S14, contributing to growth from seed to $66M Series B.
- **Core Product Innovation:** Built the customer-facing chat widget and its admin settings as the project's only front-end engineer (backend support, 2017)—it became a core product offering generating significant recurring revenue and served as proof-of-concept for React adoption.
- **Legacy Migrations:** Led the migration of 200k+ LOC from AngularJS to React/TypeScript—after leading the proof of concept, established the architectural foundations (build tooling, shared component library, coding guidelines) that remain in active use 7+ years later.
- **High-Scale Systems:** Architected an HTML/CSS sanitization system processing 30 million emails daily to ensure consistent rendering across fragmented email clients.

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- **Editor Evolution:** Drove three editor technology migrations (Summernote → Slate.js → tiptap) to meet customer WYSIWYG expectations matching Gmail/Outlook.
- **Product Identity:** Built much of the original web app UI—2017 conversation-list redesign, onboarding, settings, attachments—plus early integrations (Asana, GitHub, Pipedrive), the emoji and reaction systems, and the command palette; ran the marketing website for five years.

UI Designer & Contributor (part-time) 2012 — 2014
VideoLAN (VLC media player) *France (remote)*
- Designed the Mac interface for VLC 2.0 and led the iOS interface design for VLC's 2013 App Store return and 2014 iOS 7 redesign —contributing to one of the most downloaded open-source applications (6+ billion downloads to date).

Projects

Mac Themes Garden (macthemes.garden) May 2025 — Present
- Architected a digital archive of 4,000+ Classic Mac OS themes using Astro to generate 5,000 static pages in under 16 seconds.
- Featured by 9to5Mac, Boing Boing, OSnews, and Hacker News for its authentic, pure-CSS "System 9" interface.

Better TweetDeck (better.tw) February 2014 — July 2023
- Created and maintained a browser extension for 9 years, scaling to 80,000 weekly active users by reverse-engineering TweetDeck's minified codebase to maintain compatibility.

Open Source

- Merged fixes upstream into libraries used in production: **styled-components** (StyleSheetManager with a custom target), **Slate**, **Gatsby**, **DefinitelyTyped** (`focus-within` typings), and **js-emoji**.

Education

IUT Béziers Béziers, France
Associate's Degree in Computer Science *Sep 2012 — June 2014*

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